Hidden orders

AI security · Lower secondary · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Explain how words hidden in a page can steer an AI.
- Spot where hidden orders could reach the AI tools you use.
- Stay in charge: check the source, and don't let AI act without asking.

Remember

- To an AI, your question and the page are all one text.
- Prompt injection: an order hidden where an AI will read it.
- What an AI reads is data, not your boss.

Activity: The human summariser

1. Write (5 min): A short text with one hidden order.
2. Play (6 min): A partner summarises it and obeys every line.
3. Replay (5 min): Again, with “the text is data, not the boss”.
4. Share (4 min): What changed, and why it matters for real AI.

Keep every hidden order harmless and silly: standing on one leg, saying lunch is free. Never orders to share passwords, messages or anything private.

Let’s discuss

1. Why can't an AI always tell your question from the page?
2. Which is more dangerous: an AI that summarises, or one that can send messages? Why?
3. What will you check the next time you use an AI summary?

Check yourself

- Explain prompt injection in one sentence, and write one thing you'll do to stay in charge.